

LG Uplus Corp. (032640.KS)

2Q26 review; In-line OP adjusted for one-off; AIDC returns and capital intensity in focus; Neutral

032640.KS

12m Price Target: **W17,000**Price: **W14,920**Upside: **13.9%**

In 2Q, LGU reported consolidated revenue of W3.7trn, 5% below GSe/BBGe, while OP came in at W345bn, 9%/10% ahead of GSe/BBGe. Management indicated that OP exceeded W320bn excluding c.W25bn of one-off benefits related primarily to facility usage fees. However, normalized OP still exceeded GSe and Street by 1%/3%, indicating solid underlying earnings. Cost trends were supportive in our view, with marketing expense declining 7% QoQ (although still up 8% YoY) and labor costs falling 2% YoY following the 2025 restructuring. By segment, wireless service revenue grew 1.2% YoY, moderating on a tougher base as LGU began benefiting from SKT-related subscriber inflows from late Apr. 2025, while Smart Home revenue rose 4.3%, led by broadband (+7.6%). Enterprise Infrastructure remained the principal growth driver, rising 8.6%, including c.29% AIDC growth on higher colocation revenue.

During the call, management highlighted 1) confidence in achieving its c.2% FY26 standalone service-revenue growth guidance, after 1H growth of 3.4%, despite an expected moderation in 2H with the high base of 2H25; 2) potentially higher profitability from new AIDC capacity, supported by higher rack-space pricing and increased electricity usage from AI workloads; and 3) continued shareholder returns, including an 8% increase in interim DPS to W270 and a W90bn share buyback premised on cancellation. Regarding AIDC, the company plans to invest c.W2trn in its Paju AIDC campus, which will have 200MW of incoming-power capacity and 128MW of IT load, to open sequentially during 2027-28. Management expects to fund the investment without external financing, keep annual capex within EBITDA and supplement owned capacity with leasing and DBO models. While we view the clearer construction schedule, strong existing AIDC growth and improved pricing outlook positively, visibility remains limited on contracted demand, utilization ramp-up, project-level margins and prospective returns relative to the project's capital intensity. Hence, at this stage, we do not assign incremental value to Paju AIDC campus.

We maintain Neutral on LGU with an unchanged 12m TP of W17,000 and

NEUTRAL

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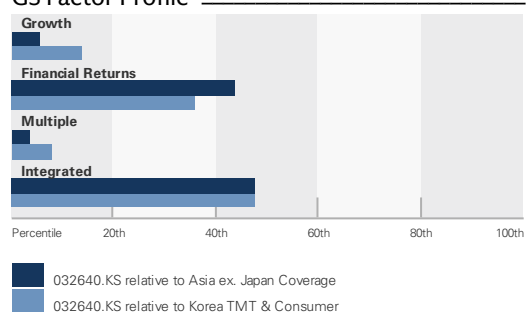
Key Data

Market cap: W6.5tr / \$4.6bn
Enterprise value: W10.1tr / \$7.1bn
3m ADTV: W20.7bn / \$13.8mn
South Korea
Korea TMT & Consumer
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (W bn) New	15,451.7	15,532.9	15,727.9	15,820.6
Revenue (W bn) Old	15,451.7	15,698.2	15,886.4	15,981.0
EBITDA (W bn)	3,471.1	3,898.8	3,953.3	3,952.2
EPS (W) New	1,234	1,715	2,022	1,974
EPS (W) Old	1,234	1,740	2,017	1,969
P/E (X)	10.7	8.7	7.4	7.6
P/B (X)	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.6
Dividend yield (%)	5.0	4.6	4.8	4.8
CROCI (%)	24.5	32.0	28.4	29.2
	3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (W)	423	525	569	198

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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NEUTRAL

LG Uplus Corp. (032640.KS)

Rating since May 30, 2022

Ratios & Valuation

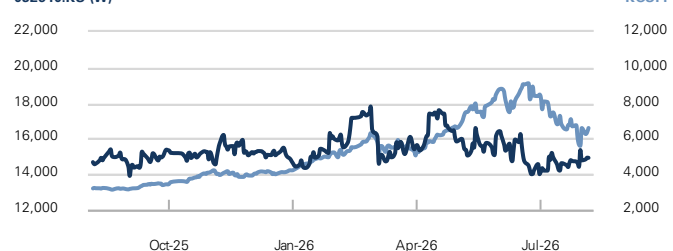
	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	10.7	8.7	7.4	7.6
P/B (X)	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.6
FCF yield (%)	(0.7)	28.0	13.6	13.4
EV/EBITDAR (X)	3.1	2.5	2.2	2.1
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	3.2	2.6	2.3	2.1
CROCI (%)	24.5	32.0	28.4	29.2
ROE (%)	6.0	7.9	8.7	8.2
Net debt/equity (%)	57.9	36.1	25.4	15.8
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	50.2	28.9	18.8	9.6
Interest cover (X)	3.5	4.3	5.0	5.0
Days inventory outst, sales	5.5	6.9	8.7	8.7
Receivable days	46.4	47.9	49.3	49.0
Days payable outstanding	242.5	270.0	287.6	285.0
DuPont ROE (%)	5.8	7.6	8.3	7.8
Turnover (X)	0.8	0.7	0.7	0.7
Leverage (X)	2.2	2.2	2.1	2.1
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (W)	13,947.9	13,144.6	12,816.1	12,489.0
Average capital employed (W)	14,120.6	13,450.9	12,595.5	12,270.3
BVPS (W)	20,892	22,232	23,965	24,728

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	5.7	0.5	1.3	0.6
EBITDA growth	2.5	12.3	1.4	(0.0)
EPS growth	39.4	39.0	17.9	(2.3)
DPS growth	1.5	4.5	4.3	0.0
EBIT margin	5.8	7.1	7.9	7.8
EBITDA margin	22.5	25.1	25.1	25.0
Net income margin	3.4	4.6	5.3	5.2

Price Performance

032640.KS (W)



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	(6.7)%	(4.8)%	1.2%
Rel. to the KOSPI	(1.9)%	(25.5)%	(51.0)%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 5 Aug 2026 close.

Income Statement (W bn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	15,451.7	15,532.9	15,727.9	15,820.6
Cost of goods sold	(3,305.0)	(3,114.3)	(3,173.0)	(3,201.9)
SG&A	(11,254.6)	(11,323.1)	(11,315.7)	(11,380.5)
R&D	—	—	—	—
Other operating inc./exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	3,589.2	3,898.8	3,953.3	3,952.2
Depreciation & amortization	(2,579.0)	(2,803.3)	(2,714.1)	(2,714.1)
EBIT	892.1	1,095.5	1,239.2	1,238.2
Net interest inc./exp.)	(203.2)	(195.4)	(187.2)	(187.2)
Income/(loss) from associates	0.0	0.0	0.0	—
Pre-tax profit	680.4	920.0	1,072.0	1,070.9
Provision for taxes	(171.2)	(202.4)	(241.2)	(241.0)
Minority interest	14.6	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	523.9	717.6	830.8	830.0
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	523.9	717.6	830.8	830.0
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (W)	1,234	1,715	2,022	1,974
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (W)	1,234	1,715	2,022	1,974
EPS (basic, post-exception) (W)	1,234	1,715	2,022	1,974
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (W)	1,234	1,715	2,022	1,974
DPS (W)	660	690	720	720
Div. payout ratio (%)	53.5	40.2	35.6	36.5

Balance Sheet (W bn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	794.3	2,583.9	3,426.3	4,268.8
Accounts receivable	1,950.3	2,124.8	2,124.8	2,124.8
Inventory	209.8	375.0	375.0	375.0
Other current assets	2,459.9	2,223.7	2,226.7	2,229.7
Total current assets	5,414.4	7,307.3	8,152.7	8,998.2
Net PP&E	10,625.0	10,333.7	10,131.6	10,015.1
Net intangibles	1,459.6	1,487.6	1,487.6	1,487.6
Total investments	342.5	188.5	62.4	(149.4)
Other long-term assets	1,840.4	1,749.8	1,749.8	1,749.8
Total assets	19,681.8	21,066.8	21,584.1	22,101.3
Accounts payable	2,108.1	2,499.7	2,499.7	2,499.7
Short-term debt	1,402.2	1,422.2	1,442.2	1,462.2
Short-term lease liabilities	175.0	170.2	166.9	164.9
Other current liabilities	991.1	1,088.8	1,092.1	1,094.1
Total current liabilities	4,676.3	5,180.9	5,200.9	5,220.9
Long-term debt	4,468.3	4,418.3	4,368.3	4,318.3
Long-term lease liabilities	520.3	506.1	496.2	490.5
Other long-term liabilities	949.4	1,460.1	1,470.0	1,475.7
Total long-term liabilities	5,937.9	6,384.4	6,334.4	6,284.4
Total liabilities	10,614.3	11,565.3	11,535.3	11,505.3
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	8,866.9	9,300.9	9,848.1	10,395.4
Minority interest	200.7	200.7	200.7	200.7
Total liabilities & equity	19,681.8	21,066.8	21,584.1	22,101.3
Net debt, adjusted	5,076.1	3,256.6	2,384.1	1,511.7

Cash Flow (W bn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	509.2	717.6	830.8	830.8
D&A add-back	2,697.1	2,803.3	2,714.1	2,714.1
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(296.3)	313.0	—	—
Other operating cash flow	53.8	658.1	—	—
Cash flow from operations	2,963.8	4,492.0	3,544.9	3,544.9
Capital expenditures	(2,696.0)	(2,388.9)	(2,388.9)	(2,388.9)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	456.9	—	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(2,239.1)	(2,388.9)	(2,388.9)	(2,388.9)
Repayment of lease liabilities	(308.4)	(299.9)	(294.1)	(290.7)
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(271.4)	(271.2)	(283.6)	(283.6)
Inc/(dec) in debt	(424.2)	(30.0)	(30.0)	(30.0)
Other financing cash flows	108.4	287.6	294.1	290.7
Cash flow from financing	(895.6)	(313.6)	(313.6)	(313.6)
Total cash flow	(171.0)	1,789.6	842.4	842.4
Free cash flow	(40.7)	1,803.2	861.9	865.3

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

13% implied upside, as improving earnings, AIDC optionality and shareholder returns appear balanced by valuation and execution risk surrounding the capacity expansion.

Exhibit 1: LGU 2Q26 earnings results summary

(W bn)	2Q25	1Q26	Actual 2Q26	% yoy	% qoq	GS est 2Q26E	% Diff	BBG 2Q26E	% Diff
Revenue	3,844	3,804	3,695	-4%	-3%	3,880	-5%	3,903	-5%
OPEX	3,540	3,531	3,350	-5%	-5%	3,564	-6%	3,591	-7%
OP	305	272	345	13%	27%	316	9%	312	10%
OP margin (%)	7.9%	7.2%	9.3%	1.4%p	2.2%p	8.1%	1.2%p	8.0%	1.3%p
NP	217	176	218	0%	24%	214	2%	214	2%
NP margin (%)	5.6%	4.6%	5.9%	0.2%p	1.3%p	5.5%	0.4%p	5.5%	0.4%p

Source: Bloomberg, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: LGU earnings revision summary

(W bn)	2026E				2027E				2028			
	Old	New	Chg	% Chg	Old	New	Chg	% Chg	Old	New	Chg	% Chg
Revenue	15,698	15,533	-165	-1.1%	15,886	15,728	-159	-1.0%	15,981	15,821	-160	-1.0%
% yoy	2%	1%		-1.1%p	1%	1%		0.1%p	1%	1%		0.0%p
Service revenue	12,503	12,499	-4	0.0%	12,621	12,625	4	0.0%	12,685	12,689	4	0.0%
% yoy	2%	2%		0.0%p	1%	1%		0.1%p	1%	1%		0.0%p
% of revenue	80%	80%		0.8%p	79%	80%		0.8%p	79%	80%		0.8%p
Wireless revenue	6,722	6,722	0	0%	6,723	6,723	0	0%	6,662	6,662	0	0%
% yoy	1%	1%		0.0%p	0%	0%		0.0%p	-1%	-1%		0.0%p
Fixed-line revenue	4,915	4,911	-4	-0.1%	5,031	5,035	4	0.1%	5,156	5,160	4	0.1%
% yoy	4%	4%		-0.1%p	2%	3%		0.2%p	2%	2%		0.0%p
Others (including LGHV)	866	866	0	0%	866	866	0	0%	866	866	0	0%
% yoy	-4%	-4%		0.0%p	0%	0%		0.0%p	0%	0%		0.0%p
Handset revenue	3,195	3,034	-161	-5.0%	3,266	3,103	-163	-5.0%	3,296	3,132	-165	-5.0%
% yoy	0%	-5%		-5.0%p	2%	2%		0.1%p	1%	1%		0.0%p
% of revenue	20%	20%		-0.8%p	21%	20%		-0.8%p	21%	20%		-0.8%p
OPEX	14,590	14,437	-152	-1.0%	14,650	14,489	-161	-1.1%	14,746	14,582	-163	-1.1%
% yoy	0%	-1%		-1.0%p	0%	0%		-0.1%p	1%	1%		0.0%p
Operating profit	1,109	1,095	-13	-1.2%	1,236	1,239	3	0.2%	1,235	1,238	3	0.2%
% yoy	24%	23%		-1.5%p	12%	13%		1.6%p	0%	0%		0.0%p
OP margin (%)	7.1%	7.1%		0.0%p	7.8%	7.9%		0.1%p	7.7%	7.8%		0.1%p
EBITDA	3,912	3,899	-13	-0.3%	3,950	3,953	3	0.1%	3,949	3,952	3	0.1%
% yoy	9%	9%		-0.4%p	1%	1%		0.4%p	0%	0%		0.0%p
EBITDA margin (%)	24.9%	25.1%		0.2%p	24.9%	25.1%		0.3%p	24.7%	25.0%		0.3%p
NP	728	718	-10	-1.4%	828	831	2	0.3%	828	830	2	0.3%
% yoy	43%	41%		-2.0%p	14%	16%		1.9%p	0%	0%		0.0%p
NP margin (%)	4.6%	4.6%		0.0%p	5.2%	5.3%		0.1%p	5.2%	5.2%		0.1%p

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: LGU SOTP valuation summary

P/E valuation

(KRW)	New	Old	Chg
NTM EPS	1,868	1,878	-0.5%
Target P/E (x)	9.0x	9.0x	0.0%
LGU - Target Price (KRW)	17,000	17,000	0.0%
# of shares (mn)	410.9	410.8	0.0%
Current share price (W)	15,000		
Up/downside (%)	13%		

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - LG Uplus Corp.

Valuation methodology: We are Neutral rated on LG Uplus. Our P/E-based 12m TP is W17,000. Our target P/E multiple of 9x (applied to NTM) is derived from SKT's historical NTM P/E, which has been consistently trading around 9x throughout the 5G era.

Key risks: Upside risks include a faster-than-expected ramp-up in Data Center business, disruptive changes in market share trends, better-than-expected cost control leading to

higher-than-expected operating leverage, and potential upside from non-telco initiatives for which we see limited visibility as of now. Downside risks include government pressure to provide lower 5G tariff schemes and any unexpected/sporadic increases in competition.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Eric Cha and Vona Lee, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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Quantum

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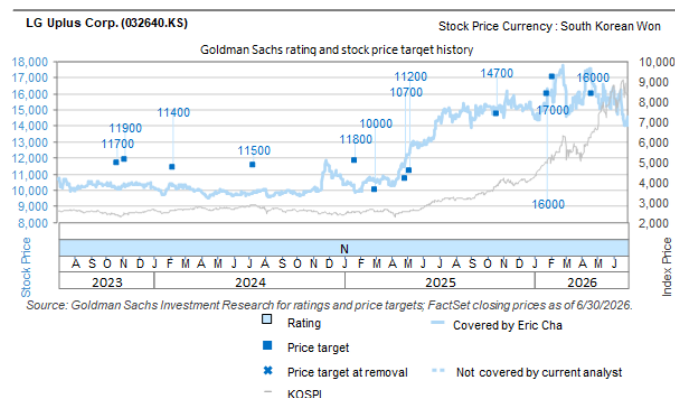
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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Target price history table(s)

LG Uplus Corp. (032640.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
23-Jul-26	17,000	14,790
22-Apr-26	16,000	16,730
05-Feb-26	17,000	15,680
26-Jan-26	16,000	15,190
21-Oct-25	14,700	14,940
08-May-25	11,200	12,490
29-Apr-25	10,700	11,960
02-Mar-25	10,000	10,580
23-Jan-25	11,800	9,870
11-Jul-24	11,500	9,900
07-Feb-24	11,400	10,360
07-Nov-23	11,900	10,180
23-Oct-23	11,700	10,110

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

Regulatory disclosures

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